

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 9
 ♥ Q 10 7 6
 ♦ 10 5 2
 ♣ 9 6 4

♠ A K 8 7 5

♥ A 4

♦ A 6 3

♣ A J 7



♠ -

♥ J 9 8 3

♦ Q J 9 7 4

♣ Q 8 5 3

♠ 10 6 4 3 2

♥ K 5 2

♦ K 8

♣ K 10 2

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	3 ♠
Pass	6 ♠		
All Pass			
6 ♠ by North in dummy.			

South decides a limit raise is better than just jumping to game. North has heard enough and bids the slam.

North is to play 6 ♠. East leads the ♦ Q.

Your first thought is probably that if you can guess the ♣ Q you will make all thirteen tricks.

So you win the ♦ K and play a ♠ to your ♠ K. When East discards a ♦ your second thought is probably that you **MUST** guess the ♣ Q just to make twelve tricks.

Hopefully your third thought is that if you use an elimination play you won't have to guess.

Play your ♠ A, leaving West with the master ♠ Q. Then eliminate ♦ s by playing ♦ A and ruffing a ♦

Now eliminate ♥ s by playing ♥ A, ♥ K, and ruffing a ♥.

You are ready for the throw-in. Play a ♠ to West's ♠ Q.

[showcards N:ST,CK,CT,C2 S:S8,CA,CJ,C7]

West has just taken the defender's first trick. First and only. Because if he now plays a red card you will ruff in one hand and discard a losing ♣ from the other. And if he plays a ♣ you will no longer have a ♣ loser.

Most elimination plays work on the same principle. The biggest difference is usually the technique you have to use to complete the eliminations.

Here it took two ruffs, one in each hand.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 9 4 2

♥ 5

♦ Q 8 2

♣ 9 6 5 3

♠ 8 3

♥ K Q 10 8 2

♦ K 9 5

♣ K 10 2



♠ A 7 6

♥ 9 7 3

♦ 10 6 4 3

♣ Q 8 7

♠ J 10 5

♥ A J 6 4

♦ A J 7

♣ A J 4

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♥
Pass	3NT	Pass	4♥
All Pass			

4♥ by South

than likely a defender will win the third ♦. He won't be happy about it, though.

[showcards N:H8,CK,CT,C2 S:HJ,CA,CJ,C4]

Whichever defender wins the ♦Q is end-played. If he plays a ♦ or a ♠ you will ruff in one hand and discard a ♣ loser from the other. But if he leads a ♣ instead you no longer have a ♣ loser.

On this Deal an elimination play will guarantee that you make your contract.

However, it also guarantees that you will not make an overtrick.

If you try the two finesses instead you **MIGHT** make an overtrick, but you also might go down 1.

Decide for yourself!

North first transfers you to ♥s, then gives you a choice of which game to play. Knowing you have an 9-card trump fit, you choose 4♥.

South is to play 4♥. The defenders start with ♠K, ♠Q, ♠A.

In addition to the two ♠s already lost you have a potential loser in each minor suit. On the plus side, you have a finesse position in ♦s and a two-way finesse in ♣s. If you work both finesses successfully you make an overtrick - if both fail you will be down 1. Or, you could try for a 100% sure end-play.

Ruff the ♠A with dummy's ♥10 and pull trumps (three rounds).

Eliminate ♦s by playing ♦K, ♦A, ♦J. If you are REALLY lucky the ♦Q will fall doubleton, but more

Board 5

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 9 7 4

♥ 10 9 5 4

♦ 8 2

♣ K 10 2

♠ 8 6 2

♥ J 3

♦ J 10 6 5

♣ 7 6 4 3



♠ Q J 10 5 3

♥ Q 8 7 2

♦ 3

♣ J 8 5

♠ A

♥ A K 6

♦ A K Q 9 7 4

♣ A Q 9

*West**North**East**South*

2 ♣

Pass

2 ♦

Pass

3 ♦

Pass

4 ♦

Pass

6 ♦

All Pass

6 ♦ by North